

Two Pointers Level 3 Problems

1. Container With Most Water

Pattern: Two Pointers + Greedy Movement

```
def max_area(height):  
    left = 0  
    right = len(height) - 1  
  
    max_area = 0  
  
    while left < right:  
        width = right - left  
  
        current_height = min(  
            height[left],  
            height[right]  
        )  
  
        area = width * current_height  
  
        max_area = max(max_area, area)  
  
        if height[left] < height[right]:  
            left += 1  
        else:  
            right -= 1  
  
    return max_area  
  
height = [1,8,6,2,5,4,8,3,7]
```

3. Sort Colors

Pattern: Three Pointers

```
def sort_colors(nums):  
    low = 0  
    mid = 0  
    high = len(nums) - 1  
  
    while mid <= high:  
        if nums[mid] == 0:  
            nums[low], nums[mid] = nums[mid], nums[low]  
  
            low += 1  
            mid += 1  
  
        elif nums[mid] == 1:  
            mid += 1  
  
        else: # nums[mid] == 2  
            nums[mid], nums[high] = nums[high], nums[mid]  
  
            high -= 1  
  
nums = [2,0,2,1,1,0]
```

2. 3Sum

Pattern: Sorting + Two Pointers

```
def sort_colors(nums):  
    low = 0  
    mid = 0  
    high = len(nums) - 1  
  
    while mid <= high:  
        if nums[mid] == 0:  
            nums[low], nums[mid] = nums[mid], nums[low]  
  
            low += 1  
            mid += 1  
  
        elif nums[mid] == 1:  
            mid += 1  
  
        else: # nums[mid] == 2  
            nums[mid], nums[high] = nums[high], nums[mid]  
  
            high -= 1  
  
nums = [2,0,2,1,1,0]
```

4. Valid Palindrome II

Pattern: Two Pointers + Conditional Skip

```
def valid_palindrome(s):  
    def is_palindrome(left, right):  
        while left < right:  
            if s[left] != s[right]:  
                return False  
  
            left += 1  
            right -= 1  
        return True  
  
    left = 0  
    right = len(s) - 1  
  
    while left < right:  
        if s[left] != s[right]:  
            return (  
                is_palindrome(left + 1, right)  
                or  
                is_palindrome(left, right - 1)  
            )  
  
        left += 1  
        right -= 1  
  
    return True  
  
s = "abca"
```